Digitalization of CAMTEL's Warehouse Management

Project Report | Douala, Cameroon | September–October 2026

Contribution: Physical inventory, Excel data preparation, verification and reconciliation support

1. Project Overview

The Digitalization of CAMTEL's Warehouse Management project began on 22 September 2026, when our team moved from CAMTEL Bepanda to the warehouse at New-Bell. On arrival, the team from Yaoundé introduced themselves and briefed us on the project, its purpose and the work planned. The project aimed to improve the organization and digital recording of materials held in CAMTEL warehouses in Douala. It covered the National Telecommunications Warehouse at New-Bell including the different zones or storage sections and warehouse at Bepanda. Inventory information was collected and checked on site, organized in Excel files, and submitted to the team responsible for processing the data in the warehouse management application.

The project was intended to make warehouse information easier to consult and maintain, improve stock visibility, and support the identification of materials and equipment. The application includes an image feature designed to help users recognize equipment and material types.

2. My Role and Responsibilities

As an intern contributing to the project, I focused on physical inventory and inventory-data preparation. I did not operate the application used to compile or process the files. My role was to collect and organize the information required by the application team, verify it against the materials present on site, and help review discrepancies identified after processing.

- Counted and identified materials and equipment in assigned warehouse sections.
- Recorded inventory details and quantities in Excel using the required structure.
- Cross-checked records against physical stock, retaining items that were present and removing entries for items that were absent.
- Prepared completed Excel files and submitted them to the responsible team for processing in the warehouse management application.

- Reviewed Excel reports of unreconciled items and helped correct inconsistencies where the available evidence supported a correction.
- Prepared a dedicated Excel file for accessories that were to be represented as kits in the platform.

3. Project Methodology and Activities

3.1 Warehouse familiarization and site preparation

On 22 September 2026, we moved from CAMTEL Bepanda to the New-Bell warehouse, where the team from Yaoundé introduced themselves and gave us an initial briefing on the project, its purpose and the planned activities. We were introduced to the warehouse environment, including how materials are stored and how information about equipment can be traced from its receipt or storage records. We also learned about the different types of equipment and materials, their uses and characteristics, and the role of the warehouse in storing items before they are dispatched for operational use. Personal protective equipment including blue coats, safety helmets, boots and gloves was provided. At the warehouse, team members were assigned to cleaning the site and arranging materials by section before inventory work proceeded.

3.2 Physical inventory and Excel data preparation

An existing inventory file was provided as a reference, alongside a PDF version. Team members were divided into groups: one group entered actual inventory information into Excel, while other groups checked the stock on site and supplied the required details. The Excel file served as structured input for the application team. Entries were updated using the physical count, and cross-checking was performed to make the records reflect what was actually present.

The work began with the Chinese storage section and continued across other sections, including the Regional storage section, the Ground-Floor storage section, the National storage section, the Bepanda storage section and the External storage section. The team waited for on-site counting results before finalizing the relevant Excel files.

3.3 Submission and reconciliation support

When a file was completed, it was handed to the responsible personnel for processing through the warehouse management application. The application team handled that processing. Where the subsequent compilation identified unresolved or unreconciled entries, an Excel report was shared for review. My contribution was to help investigate

the listed inconsistencies and correct source information where the evidence supported a correction.

One example concerned the location (storage section) label "EXT," which represented an outdoor area associated with the New-Bell warehouse but had been assigned to another location. The location information was corrected, and the relevant file was sent to the responsible staff member for further processing.

3.4 Accessories and kit preparation

The team later decided that accessories would be represented as kits in the platform. The head of the application team explained the required Excel structure and demonstrated an example. I then completed the dedicated accessories file using information from materials that had already been reconciled and submitted it for processing.

4. Activity Timeline

Date	Activity
22 September 2026	Project kickoff at the New-Bell warehouse after moving from CAMTEL Bepanda. The team from Yaoundé introduced themselves and briefed us on the project objectives, purpose and planned activities.
23–24 September 2026	Familiarized myself with the warehouse, reviewed inventory reference files, updated the Excel inventory and cross-checked recorded items against physical stock.
25 September 2026	Completed and submitted the Chinese storage section file. The application team identified nine unresolved cases during compilation; these were reviewed and resolved by the responsible team. Work then began on the Regional storage section.
26–28 September 2026	Completed the Regional storage section file and the Ground-Floor storage section file and submitted them for processing. Began the National storage section inventory file.
29–30 September 2026	Completed the National storage section Excel file and received an Excel report of unreconciled equipment

	for follow-up.
1 October 2026	Corrected the location classification for the outdoor "EXT" area associated with New-Bell and forwarded the relevant file for further processing and completed the Bepanda storage section for submission
2–6 October 2026	Participated in inventory work for the warehouse that is located at CAMTEL Bepanda. Prepared and submitted the Excel file for accessories to be treated as kits in the platform.
6–7 October 2026	The team completed the on-site inventory of Bepanda warehouses. The remaining task was to compile the results into an Excel file and send it to the responsible person. A status update was also submitted to the Human Resource Department after completion.
8 October 2026	Completed an update to the inventory information in the Excel file and submitted it to the responsible personnel.
9 October 2026	The assigned tasks were completed, and the updated inventory files were submitted to the responsible team members, marking the completion of my assigned contribution to the project, with no further tasks or instructions communicated afterward.

5. Tools and Working Methods

- Microsoft Excel: recording, organizing, updating and checking inventory information.
- Excel and PDF reference files: supporting comparison with the physical stock.
- Physical counting and visual identification: confirming the presence and location of materials and equipment.
- Warehouse management application: used by the responsible application team to process submitted data; it was not operated by me.

6. Key Observations and Lessons Learned

- Reliable digital inventory depends on reliable source data; software cannot compensate for inaccurate counts or poorly structured input.
- Physical verification is essential. Recorded items should be checked against what is actually present, and absent items or location errors should be corrected before submission.
- Clear location labels and consistent naming reduce the risk of assigning materials to the wrong warehouse or section.
- Inventory discrepancies can arise from human error, making review and reconciliation important parts of the process.
- Stock buffers or tolerance margins should not be applied automatically. Variances especially for critical equipment such as routers should follow CAMTEL's approved stock-control procedures and be supported by verified counts.
- Coordination between inventory teams and the application team is important because each stage depends on timely, accurate information from the previous stage.

7. Contribution and Learning Outcomes

This project gave me practical experience in inventory-data preparation, physical stock verification, Excel-based record management and discrepancy follow-up within a digitalization initiative. It helped me understand the relationship between warehouse operations, structured data and software systems used to manage operational information. Working with other team members also strengthened my attention to detail, coordination and appreciation of data accuracy in a real working environment.

8. Conclusion

My contribution to the Digitalization of CAMTEL's Warehouse Management project focused on preparing accurate inventory data for digital processing. Through physical counting, Excel updates, cross-checking, file submission and follow-up on unreconciled entries, I supported the work needed to build a more consistent digital view of warehouse materials. The experience reinforced an important lesson: successful digitalization depends not only on the software platform, but also on the quality, accuracy and organization of the information provided to it.

Acknowledgement

I am grateful to the CAMTEL team members and supervisors who guided us through the inventory activities, explained warehouse procedures, and showed us how the work was carried out. Their guidance helped me gain practical insight into the coordination required for a warehouse digitalization project.